HTML Cheatsheet

PRAVAN · Chapter 2 · Static sites

THE BIG IDEA

You type a URL → the browser asks DNS for the IP → asks the web server for the page → the server sends back an **HTML document** → the browser reads it and displays the page.

HTML is a **markup language**, not a programming language. It only *describes* content. Behaviour comes later with JavaScript.

ANATOMY OF AN ELEMENT

```
<h1>  Hello  </h1>
 opening  content  closing (same name + /)
```

With content

`<p>text</p>`

Empty (self-closing)

`<br/> <hr/> <img/>`

NESTING RULES

- Think of parentheses: close what you opened last. **No overlapping.**
- Indent *while* you write, so nesting stays readable.

```
OK   <a> text <b> text </b> </a>
BAD  <a> text <b> text </a> </b>
```

BLOCK VS INLINE

Block

Takes the full width, stacks vertically.

`p` `h1 – h6` `ul` `div`

Inline

Takes only its content's width, no line break.

`strong` `em` `a` `span`

> Inline inside block: ✓. Block inside inline: ×.

Document & text

The skeleton, then the tags you'll use most

MINIMUM SKELETON

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
  <head>  settings, not displayed  </head>
  <body>  everything visible       </body>
</html>
```

The page is a **tree** (`html` → `head` , `body` → ...). This tree is the **DOM**, which JavaScript will manipulate later.

HEADINGS & PARAGRAPHS

`<h1>` – `<h6>`	Headings, level 1 (main) to 6. Block. Choose by **meaning**, not size.
`<p>`	Paragraph. Block. Line breaks in your source are ignored.
` `	Forced line break (addresses, poems). Not for spacing: use CSS.
`<pre>`	Keeps spaces and line breaks exactly (console output).
`<wbr>`	Suggests where a long word or URL may wrap.

> One `h1` per page, never skip levels. It helps accessibility, SEO and maintenance.

INLINE TEXT TAGS

`<strong>`	Important (bold by default)
`<em>`	Emphasis (italic by default)
`<small>`	Side notes, legal text
`<mark>`	Highlight (yellow)
`<sup>` `<sub>`	Superscript / subscript (x^2, H_2O)
`<del>` `<ins>`	Removed / added text
`<span>`	Neutral wrapper, for CSS/JS
`<bdi>`	Isolates text with another direction (e.g. Arabic)

Quotes, lists & links

Meaning-first tags

QUOTES & CODE

`<q>`	Short quote
`<blockquote>`	Long quote, own block
`<cite>`	Title of a cited work
`<abbr title="">`	Abbreviation, tooltip shows full text
`<code>` `<kbd>` `<var>` `<samp>`	Code, key press, variable, program output
`<b>` `<i>` `<u>` `<s>`	Look only: bold, alternate voice, underline, outdated

LISTS

```
<ul>
  <li>bullet</li>
</ul>
```

Unordered, bullets

```
<ol>
  <li>first</li>
</ol>
```

Ordered, numbered

`<dl>` + `<dt>` term + `<dd>` description: glossary, FAQ. Lists are also the right tool for **navigation menus**.

LINKS

```
<a href="https://site.com" target="_blank">Visit</a>
```

- `href` = destination, `target="_blank"` = new tab
- **Bookmark:** put `id="top"` on an element, link with `href="#top"`
- `<base>` in the head sets a common URL prefix
- `<hr/>` is a thematic break: "the topic changes here"

> Attributes live in the opening tag: `name="value"`.

Media, tables & layout

Bigger building blocks, plus the habits that matter

MEDIA

`<img src alt/>`	`src` = path or URL, `alt` = fallback text. Prefer SVG, WebP, AVIF. Set width/height.
`<figure>` `<figcaption>`	Image + caption as one unit
`<picture>`	Different images per screen size
`<video controls>`	Contains several `<source>` formats. Extras: `autoplay muted loop poster`
`<audio controls>`	Same idea (mp3, wav, ogg)
`<object>`	Embeds external content (e.g. a PDF)

TABLES

```
<table>
  <tr> <th>Name</th> <th>Age</th> </tr>
  <tr> <td>Sam</td>  <td>21</td>  </tr>
</table>
```

`tr` row · `td` cell · `th` header cell. For long tables use `thead` `tbody` `tfoot`.

CONTAINERS

Generic

`<div>` block group

`<span>` inline group

No meaning, only for styling.

Semantic (HTML5)

`header` `nav` `main` `aside` `footer`

Prefer these when they fit.

ALSO GOOD TO KNOW

`<dialog>` native popup · `<meter>` value in a known range · `<progress>` task progress

Head, habits & history

The last bits worth remembering

WHAT GOES IN <HEAD>

`<title>`	Page title (required)
`<meta>`	Metadata: encoding, description...
`<link>`	External resources, e.g. a CSS file
`<style>`	Embedded CSS
`<script>`	Embedded JavaScript

GOOD HABITS

Structure

Doctype on line 1
Semantic tags
One `h1`, ordered headings
Always add `alt` to images
Don't overuse `div` / `span`

Code

Indent properly
Close every tag
Lowercase
Comment: `<!-- note -->`
Relative paths, files in folders

> A page that renders isn't necessarily correct. Browsers forgive mistakes, so validate with the **W3C Validator** (errors, warnings, or valid).

DOCTYPE & HISTORY

- `<!DOCTYPE html>` tells the browser it's HTML5. Without it the browser enters **quirks mode**, with inconsistent rendering.
- HTML descends from **SGML** (like XML). Versions: HTML 2.0 (1995) → 4.01 (1997) → XHTML (2000–06) → **HTML5** (2007–today).
- Maintained by **WHATWG** (browser makers, "living standard") and **W3C**. An "HTML 6" is unlikely.

GO FURTHER

ARIA for screen readers · **SEO** and Schema.org microdata · more tags at w3schools.com/tags